Corpora & Discourse Conference 2026 Abstract Submission

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What are you submitting? *

- ○ Abstract for Poster Presentation
- ◉ Abstract for Paper Presentation

Paper Presentation Title *

A user-friendly tool for corpus-based analysis of discourse using Lexical Multidimensional Analysis

Paper Presentation Abstract (Maximum of 4000 characters) *

Lexical Multidimensional Analysis (LMDA; Berber Sardinha and Fitzsimmons-Doolan 2025) is an extension of Multidimensional Analysis (MDA; Biber, 1988, 1995) that was developed to detect lexical co-occurrence patterns that point to underlying discourses. As a development of the so-called Flagstaff School of Corpus Linguistics (cf. Cortes and Csomay 2015), LMDA shares principles with MDA, such as linguistic cooccurrence signaling a common underlying trait, multidimensionality, and a text-linguistic focus (Veirano Pinto, Berber Sardinha, and Delfino 2026). MDA has been criticized for being unnecessarily complicated (Xiao and McEnery 2005; Egbert, Larsson, and Biber 2020), and so LMDA inherits these criticisms by extension. We recognize the complexity of LMDA. The method relies on multivariate statistics and involves several processing steps, including part-of-speech tagging, lemmatization, feature selection, and feature counting on a text-by-text basis. It may also require converting continuous frequency measures to nominal values or applying frequency normalization. At the analytical stage, correlations are computed, and factor analysis is applied to identify latent sets of co-occurring features, followed by analysis of variation across texts or groups. Consequently, a successful implementation of LMDA presupposes familiarity with statistical reasoning and with statistical software such as SPSS, SAS, or R; although programming is not required, writing one's own scripts for automating parts of the workflow is an advantage. In this paper, we introduce a new application that simplifies running an LMDA by offloading the burden of corpus processing and statistical analysis, requiring only that the user provide a corpus and adjust a few settings. The app is free to use and runs on different operating systems. To conduct an analysis, the user uploads a corpus, specifies the language, sets the minimum factor loading, and defines whether POS categories should be filtered out and if keywords need to be computed. The user also toggles the data type as categorical, ordinal, or interval. The app then tags the texts, performs POS filtering if needed, applies the appropriate correlation method based on the data type, performs an initial factor analysis, and presents an eigenvalue list to help the user determine the number of factors. Once the user sets this number, the app completes the factor extraction, removes low communality features and scores each text on each factor. The app output includes, among other elements, the factorial pattern, a spreadsheet containing feature counts and factor scores, and a sample of high-scoring texts from each pole of each dimension to help users interpret the factors as dimensions. It is hoped that this tool will help make LMDA more widely adopted by researchers interested in describing discourse patterns.

References

Berber Sardinha, Tony, and Shannon Fitzsimmons-Doolan. 2025. Lexical Multidimensional Analysis: Identifying Discourses and Ideologies. Cambridge:

Which of the following topics best describes your proposed work? *

- academic, scientific, technological and medical discourse(s)

- ○ comparative studies
- ○ discourse(s) and identities
- ○ discourse(s) in language acquisition, language learning and teaching
- ○ discursive and/or language change over time (including historical analyses)
- ○ discourse(s) and social issues (e.g., health, the environment, gender and sexuality, technology, politics and polycrises)
- ○ figurative language in discourse (e.g. metaphor, metonymy, irony)
- ○ institutional discourse(s)
- ○ intercultural discourses
- ○ language ideology and policy
- ○ media, social media, new media and hybrid text types
- ◉ methodological innovations in corpus and discourse analysis approaches
- ○ multimodality and corpora
- ○ reflective contributions on the assumptions, practices, ethical dilemmas and implications of corpus and discourse analysis research
- ○ corpus stylistics and literary discourse
- ○ translation studies and discourse(s)
- ○ Other

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